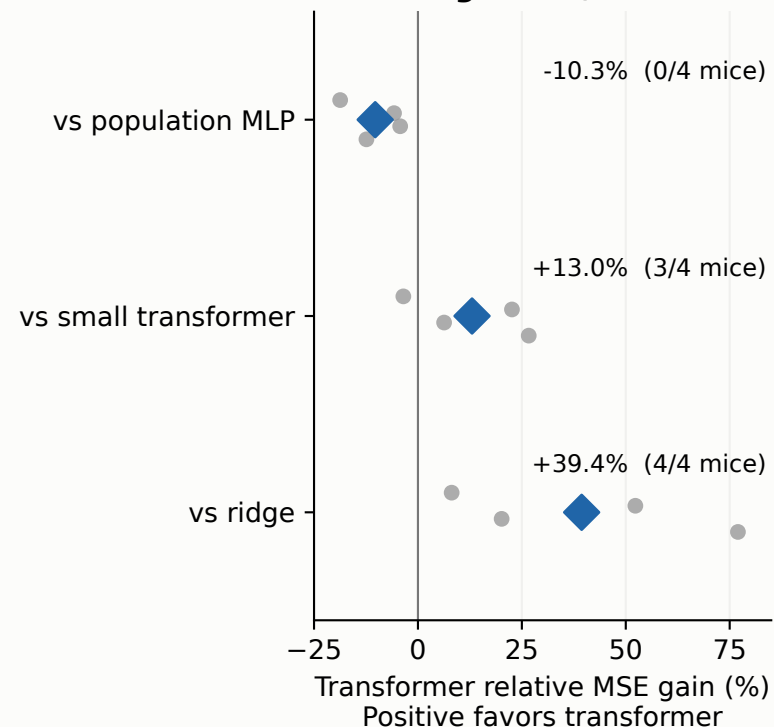
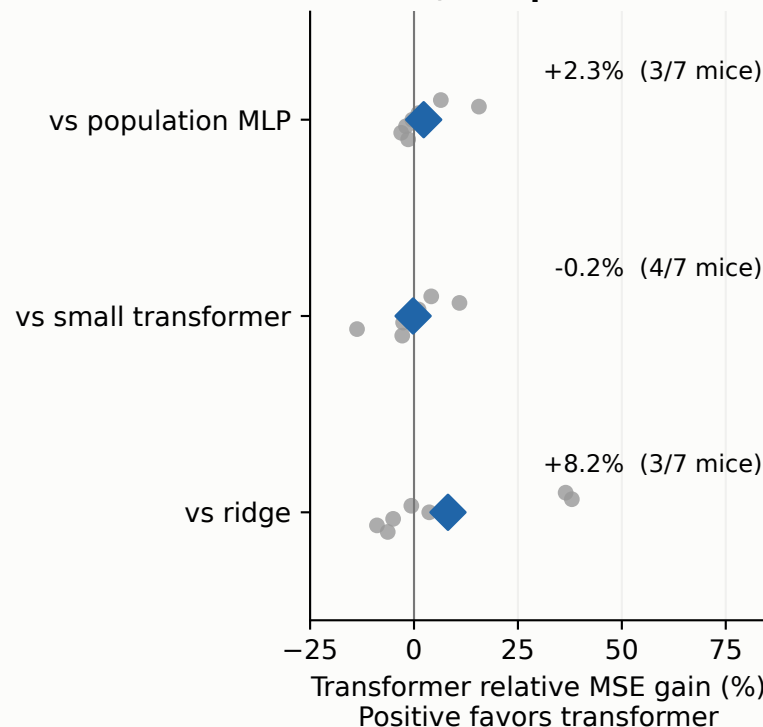


Neural behavior decoding: strong controls change the conclusion

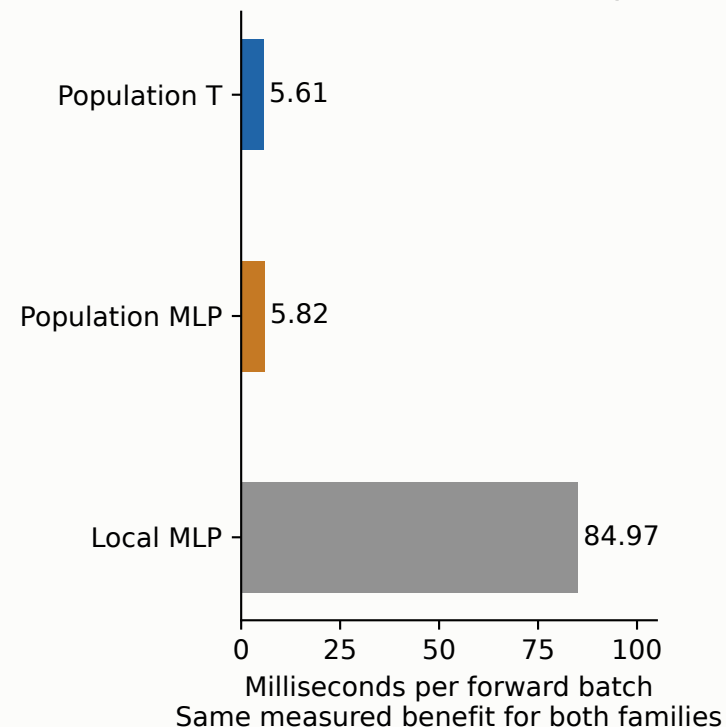
**Development: 4 reused mice
6 training seeds; shared fits**



**Separate cohort: 7 mice
3 seeds; independent fits**



**Population compression is cheaper
Saved CPU benchmark; batch 64**



Gray dots = individual mice; diamonds = equal-mouse means, not confidence intervals. Separate-cohort gates all FAIL (Holm $p = 1$). Development is exploratory. CPU timings exclude preprocessing and I/O; quality is not equal across architectures. Releases are not time-harmonized.